

December

19



1974

Mini computer

A pioneering do-it-yourself computer kit went on sale for the first time. The Altair 8800, produced by US company MITS, came with 256 bytes of memory – enough to store one sentence of text.

Also on this day

1843 The classic Christmas ghost story of redemption, *A Christmas Carol*, by British author Charles Dickens, was published.

1958 US president Dwight D Eisenhower sent a message into orbit. His voice became the first ever to be transmitted into space.

1983 The original football FIFA World Cup trophy, known as the Jules Rimet Trophy, was stolen in Brazil. It has never been recovered.

Born this day

1875 Carter G Woodson, Black American historian. In 1926 he launched the celebration of Negro History Week, which helped to inspire Black History Month.



Heating up 2019

Australia declared a state of national emergency as firefighters battled against nearly 100 bushfires. Caused by a record-breaking heatwave and extreme wind conditions, the raging fires spread from regions in South Australia to the east of the country.

2018

Drone delivery

A baby on an island in Vanuatu became the first to receive a vaccine delivered by a drone. This was part of the UNICEF charity's aim to immunize people living in remote communities.

